

Coaching other team members to help and support each other

In addition to holding yourself accountable for how you contribute to a psychologically safe team, you should also encourage and coach others to do the same. Psychological safety is truly a team sport! As you move from individual actions to having an ongoing and shared team conversation, you raise your expectations for one another, and create positive momentum.

“A supportive team doesn’t happen by chance — it is built through intentional coaching, encouragement, and open conversations.”

How can you coach team members to help others?

Here are some examples of what good and great coaching looks like.



What **good** looks like

Simple but meaningful ways to encourage and support others.

1



Encourage peer recognition (e.g., ask the team to write a 2-minute thank you note every day).

2



Remind team members that it is everyone’s role to help improve the experience of others on the team.



What **great** looks like

More intentional and deeper actions to build a supportive team culture.

1



Encourage team members to give their views (e.g., everyone should withhold judgment when thinking of ideas).

2



Coach team members to support each other (e.g., ask them to encourage each other to speak up).

3



Steer team members away from behaviors that might limit psychological safety.

4



Provide feedback and coaching to individual team members on their contributions to psychological safety.

Coaching other team members to help and support each other

Read the scenario below and choose the best response. This will help you practice how to coach team members and build a more supportive team culture.



Jonas

"I am a little fed up. Sam never seems to get things right the first time, and I am always left to fix his mistakes."



How would you respond to Jonas?

What would you say to Jonas?

Select the best answer and click Submit.

A

You seem frustrated, Jonas, and I'm sorry you're feeling that way. It happens sometimes—there's usually someone on the team who is not meeting expectations.

B

That sounds really frustrating, Jonas. What do you think is going on with Sam? It's possible he's still getting familiar with the work or not aware of these mistakes. Have you spoken to him about it or explored what support he might need?



C

I would be frustrated too, Jonas. Since this has happened repeatedly, I think you should bring this up directly with Sam and let him know that you're tired of fixing his mistakes.

D

That is frustrating, Jonas. I think you should set clearer expectations with Sam so that he can improve and avoid making the same mistakes.

Submit Answer →

Common misconceptions about psychological safety

Although the individual actions of the REACH model might seem straightforward, putting them into practice can be challenging. One reason is that there are a few common misunderstandings about what it means to have a psychologically safe environment. Once these ideas are clearer, you will see even more opportunities to build psychological safety within your team.



01

Misconception

Psychological safety means there are no conflicts or challenges. Everyone must always be nice.

Many people believe that a psychologically safe team never disagrees or faces different opinions. They think “not agreeing” is something to avoid.

Fact

Psychological safety actually allows for open and honest discussions, including diverse viewpoints.

Psychologically safe teams listen deeply, understand different perspectives, and respect each other—even when there is disagreement. They are willing to share ideas, challenge each other, and work together to find better solutions.



02

Misconception

Psychological safety means no accountability, no focus on performance, and ultimately unproductive teams.

Some people worry that a psychologically safe team will have lower standards, be too comfortable, and become less productive because people won't be challenged.

Fact

Psychological safety actually improves team performance and productivity.

Research shows that psychologically safe teams take smart risks, are more honest about their work, openly give and receive feedback, and set higher performance goals. It leads to better outcomes, not lower performance.



03

Misconception

Psychological safety means every little decision must be discussed from every possible angle, making the team inefficient.

Some people think psychologically safe teams spend too much time in meetings, overanalyzing every decision because everyone's opinion must be heard.

Fact

Psychologically safe teams are actually more efficient in decision-making.

They are comfortable speaking up with relevant input, but they also trust that the team will make the decision. Not every decision needs extended discussion. There is clarity on when to involve the team, and the process is more focused and efficient.



Key takeaways from this module

In this module, we have covered the following tools and insights to help you create a more psychologically safe and high-performing team.



REACH model

Use this framework to create a safe team environment by reframing mistakes, encouraging all voices, appreciating contributions, and coaching your team to help each other.

Recommended resources

You may also wish to explore these resources:



VIDEO

Building a psychologically safe workplace



GUIDE

Google's Project Aristotle:
Understand team effectiveness



INTERVIEW

Psychological safety, emotional intelligence,
and leadership in a time of flux



“

A psychologically safe environment unlocks better ideas, stronger collaboration, and higher performance.

—



Relationships & Well-Being in summary

Throughout this course, you have built practical skills and mindsets to strengthen your well-being, build meaningful relationships, and create a psychologically safe environment — for yourself and those around you.

*Healthier
People
Stronger
Teams
A Brighter
Tomorrow*

Key learnings from this course

01



Improve your well-being

Evaluate and take steps to improve your current state of well-being across multiple dimensions.

- Understand the key dimensions of well-being
- Assess your current state
- Take practical steps to improve and sustain your well-being

02



Build stronger relationships

Establish strong relationships with others by being attentive, vulnerable, empathetic, and compassionate.

- Be a more active and intentional listener
- Show vulnerability and authenticity
- Practice empathy and compassion
- Build trust and deeper connections with others

03



Create a psychologically safe team environment

Foster a team environment where people are not afraid to speak up, take risks, and make mistakes.

- Encourage open and inclusive discussions
- Value diverse perspectives
- Respond constructively to mistakes
- Help others feel safe, respected, and empowered to contribute



PUTTING IT INTO PRACTICE

Apply the lessons in your daily life

We hope you can apply some of the lessons learned to your day-to-day life decisions, whether it's using the AVEC framework in a difficult conversation or creating a recovery plan to help you recharge and re-energize your emotional well-being.



KEEP LEARNING

Refer to the Forward Learning Workbook

To revisit the key learnings from these sections, please refer to the Forward Learning Workbook, which provides a summary of the covered material and space to document your reflections.